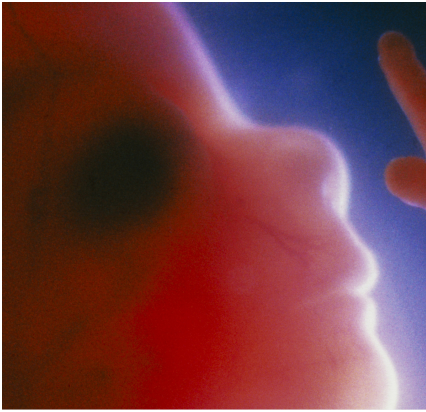




YOU ARE **9 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

213 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The baby's facial features are becoming more distinctive by this stage. The very fine eyelids have now completely fused over the developing eye and will remain closed until approximately the 26th week of pregnancy.

“Just as you’ve become used to the idea you’re pregnant, you may discover that you’re carrying more than one baby.”

Do you have an instinct that you’re having twins? Some women, even very early in pregnancy, suspect they’re carrying more than one baby simply because they feel “more pregnant.” Signs of a multiple pregnancy include highly sensitive breasts, and extreme morning sickness and fatigue. In a multiple pregnancy, your uterus might also be larger than expected. Your doctor may be able to feel it rising into your lower belly from this week, instead of from 12 weeks.

Whether or not you suspect anything, the [first ultrasound scan](#) will show definitely if you are carrying more than one baby.

ASK A MOM

I’m delighted we’re having twins but how will I manage? I felt the same when I was expecting and had so many worries—“Will I be able to breast-feed two babies? How many cribs will I need?” At first, your head is likely to be spinning with these thoughts, as you get used to the idea of your twin pregnancy.

To give yourself time to come to terms with the news, you may prefer to keep it to yourselves for a few weeks. What you’ll find is that family and friends react differently. Responses can range from pure joy (usually from thrilled grandparents) to envy or a bit of scaremongering (from friends and strangers).

We found it helpful to talk to others who were expecting twins or who were already parents to twins. Visit the website of the National Organization of Mothers of Twins Clubs to find a local group.

THE SHOCKING NEWS

The news that you’re having two or more babies may not always be delivered with the greatest tact. For instance, the sonographer may look at the scan and say that “something needs checking.” This sounds worrying, of course, but remember, they are only being cautious before giving you the life-changing news. The sonographer may also be checking your twins for size, to